about renaming a place. On the contrary, the opposing side debates that the issue of name, etc. is merely being brought across to erase the Muslim identity of India. Though the truth is certainly far from the shallow debates which are covered with layers and layers of nuances, it is not just black and white. But the density of apologia being read for the Tīmūrid Gūrkāniyās is thickening with each passing day. Various strands of public figures, ranging from film stars and industrialists to journalists etc. have some way or the other tried to be part of these debates passionately.

As a curious mind, the subject drew an objective interest from my end. I wanted to know about those who called themselves 'Tīmūrid Gūrkāniyān' and got popularized as 'Mūghals'. The journey began with the purpose of knowing more than telling the tale to others. I was expecting that these much-debated subjects would already have a lot of literary works based on primary contemporary sources. But the truth was stranger than my expectations. It was impossible to get hold of works in detail about history of Babur, the man who founded the empire. People have translated the Persian version of the *Baburnama*, and a few books have been written as biographies of Babur but nothing substantial encompassing complete details has appeared recently, except *Babur: Tīmūrid Prince and Mughal Emperor* by Stephen F. Dale.[*] This is an attempt to showcase the complete life of Babur using primary sources but very briefly. A book which can be considered one of the most substantial works on Babur (except the *Baburnama*) is *Babar* written by Stanley Lane-Poole, published way back in AD 1899, but it was too concise with a count of around 200 pages.[†] Not so long ago (2015) a book appeared centred on the life of Babur, titled *Babur: Conqueror of Hindustan* written by Royina Grewal, but this falls under the genre of historical fiction and is more of a eulogizing project, far from the truth on many accounts.[‡] The concern with the *Baburnama* is that it rightfully focuses entirely on Babur and fails to give relative context from an Indian perspective. While Babur was chronicling his life, he was not entirely aware of the happenings around the world. And today when I superimposed the *Baburnama* with the happenings around the world during that period, an entirely new perspective has appeared.

While most only saw a protagonist or an antagonist in him, I began to see him as a human being. Like any other human being, he too was affected by the circumstances and legacy which were nowhere under his control. There were moments when I felt pain for him, while there were times when I was anguished because of his deeds. He was as good or as bad of a human being as a warlord of the Tīmūrid clan in general would be. Without any exception, he was